Addendum to WSI for OVL Phase 1 Area 2, Area 4, Swale and Bell Mouth excavations, Area 2, 3, 4 and Swale Evaluation, Geotechnical Investigation Works South Marston Swindon Wiltshire

Addendum to Written scheme of investigation for archaeological excavation

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Sign-off History:

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1	30/01/2025	Kamil Orzechowski	Simon Markus	Scope update to approved WSI
2	02/04/2025	-	Simon Markus	Further scope amendments

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1 Introduction

1.1 *Project background*

1.1.1 This Addendum to the Written Scheme of Investigation (or WSI) for an archaeological evaluation on the site OVL (Old Vicarage Lane), South Marston, Swindon, Wiltshire has been commissioned from MOLA by Orion Heritage on behalf of the client Taylor Wimpey. This document should be read in conjunction with the main WSI (MOLA 2024).

1.1.2 The original WSI, prepared by MOLA remains unchanged and in full effect, with this document serving as an extension to cover further evaluation and requirements.

1.1.3 The additional areas for further excavation and trenches have been approved by Wiltshire Council's Archaeological advisor and will be conducted within the scope of the existing archaeological mitigation strategy, adhering to the methodologies outlined in the main WSI.

2 Scope Amendments

2.1 *Additional Evaluation Trenches*

2.1.1 In addition to the evaluation trenches outlined in the original WSI, a further 56 evaluation trenches have been added, primarily focussing on areas east of OVL (46 trenches). Three trenches are proposed within Primary Street Field 10 (the western end of the area), three trenches around the periphery to Area 4 and four trenches immediately north of Area 4, north of the public bridleway (Figs 1-3).

2.1.2 The methodology for the excavation, recording and reporting of these trenches will follow that laid out in the main WSI (Section 3).

Areas east of OVL (Fig 1)

2.1.3 Within the overarching WSI produced by Orion (2022), further evaluation works were designed east of OVL to enhance previously undertaken evaluations. A number of these have been brought forward into the current programme of works:

- Area 8: Seven trenches measuring 40m by 1.8m (Trenches 12-18)
- Area 11: Eight trenches measuring 40m by 1.8m (Trenches 19-26)
- Area 13: Sixteen trenches measuring 40m by 1.8m (Trenches 27-42)
- Area 14: Five trenches measuring 40m by 1.8m (Trenches 47-51)
- Area 18: Three trenches measuring 40m by 1.8m (Trenches 52-54)
- Area 19: Two trenches measuring 40m by 1.8m (Trenches 55-56)
- Area 21: Four trenches measuring 40m by 1.8m (Trenches 65-69)

Area 4 and fields to the north (Fig 2)

2.1.4 A total of seven additional trenches are proposed, split across three fields; four (Trenches 113-116) measuring 40m by 1.8m and three (Trenches 110-112) measuring 30m by 1.8m. These trenches have been designed to assess how far archaeology within Area 4 continues into areas affected by development.

Primary Street Field 10 (Fig 3)

2.1.5 Three additional trenches (117-119) measuring 20m by 1.8m are proposed in this area to test the accuracy of the geophysical survey and determine what (if any) further work is required in the field.

3 Post-excavation reporting

3.1.1 Findings from these additional trenches will be incorporated into an evaluation report alongside the trenches detailed in the main WSI (MOLA 2024). This reporting will follow the methodology for reporting set out in the main WSI (Section 4).

3.1.2 Following the completion of field work, an interim report will be produced summarising the results of the evaluation areas and will include plans of those areas and all associated archaeological features. This will be completed within 4 weeks of finishing the fieldwork as outlined in the WSI and this addendum.

3.1.3 This will comprise a basic description of the archaeology, including a general description of the site stratigraphy, provisional dating of finds, general plans and sections of the site and of key features within it as well as details of short-term archiving arrangements and subsequent post-excavation works.

3.1.4 Following completion of the interim report, MOLA will produce the evaluation report of the site records and finds which will be due within four months of finishing fieldwork, unless otherwise agreed in writing with the archaeological advisor.

4 Bibliography

MOLA 2024 *WSI for OVL Phase 1, Area 2, Area 4, Swale and Bell Mouth excavations, Area 2, 3, 4 and Swale Evaluation, Geotechnical Investigation Works South Marston Swindon Wiltshire, MOLA 2024*

Orion Heritage, 2022, *Land at South Marston & Rowborough North of the A420 Eastern Villages Swindon Site Wide Over-Arching Archaeological Written Scheme of Investigation*

5 Figures

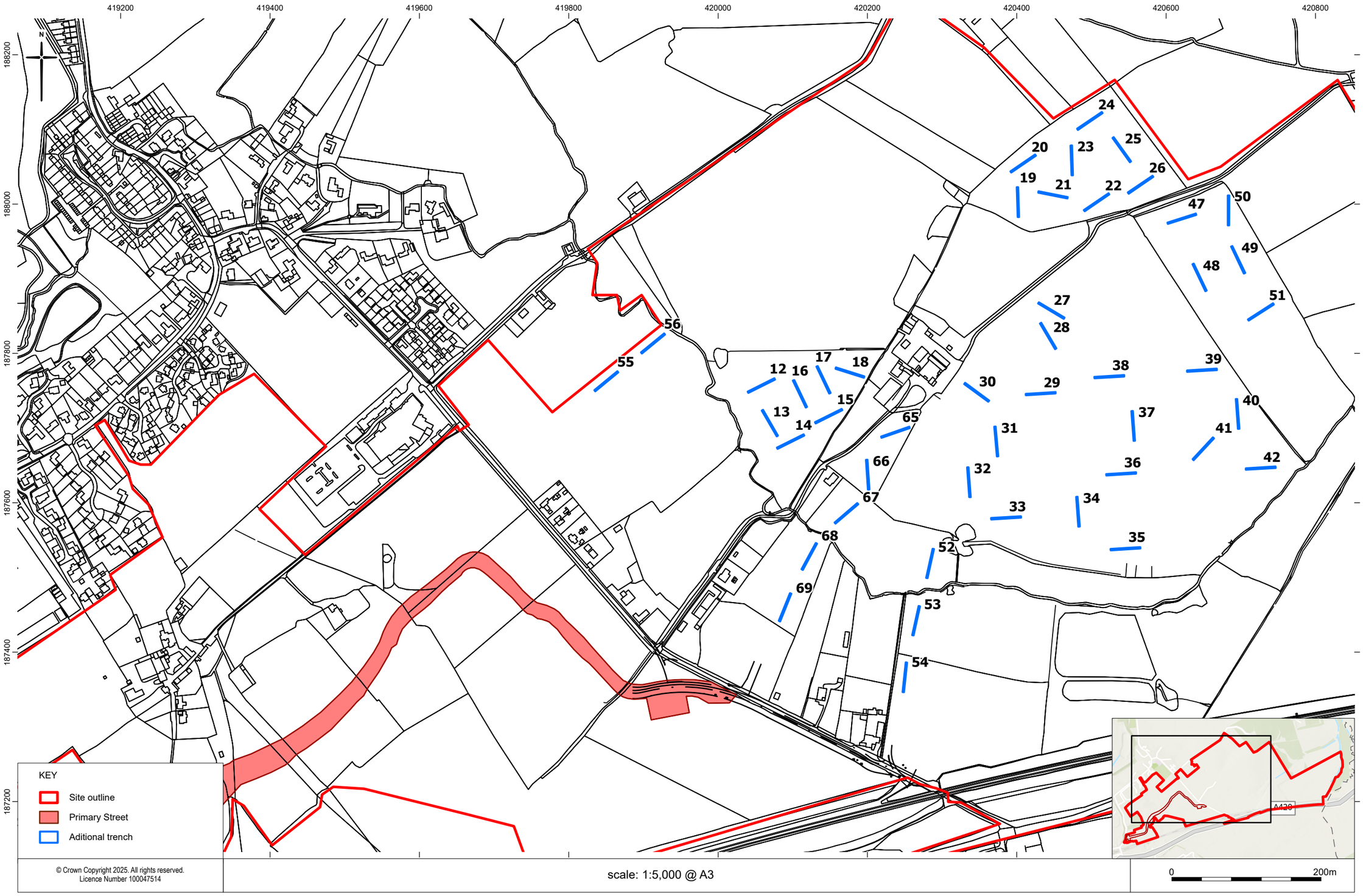

Fig 1 Evaluation Trenches from east of OVL

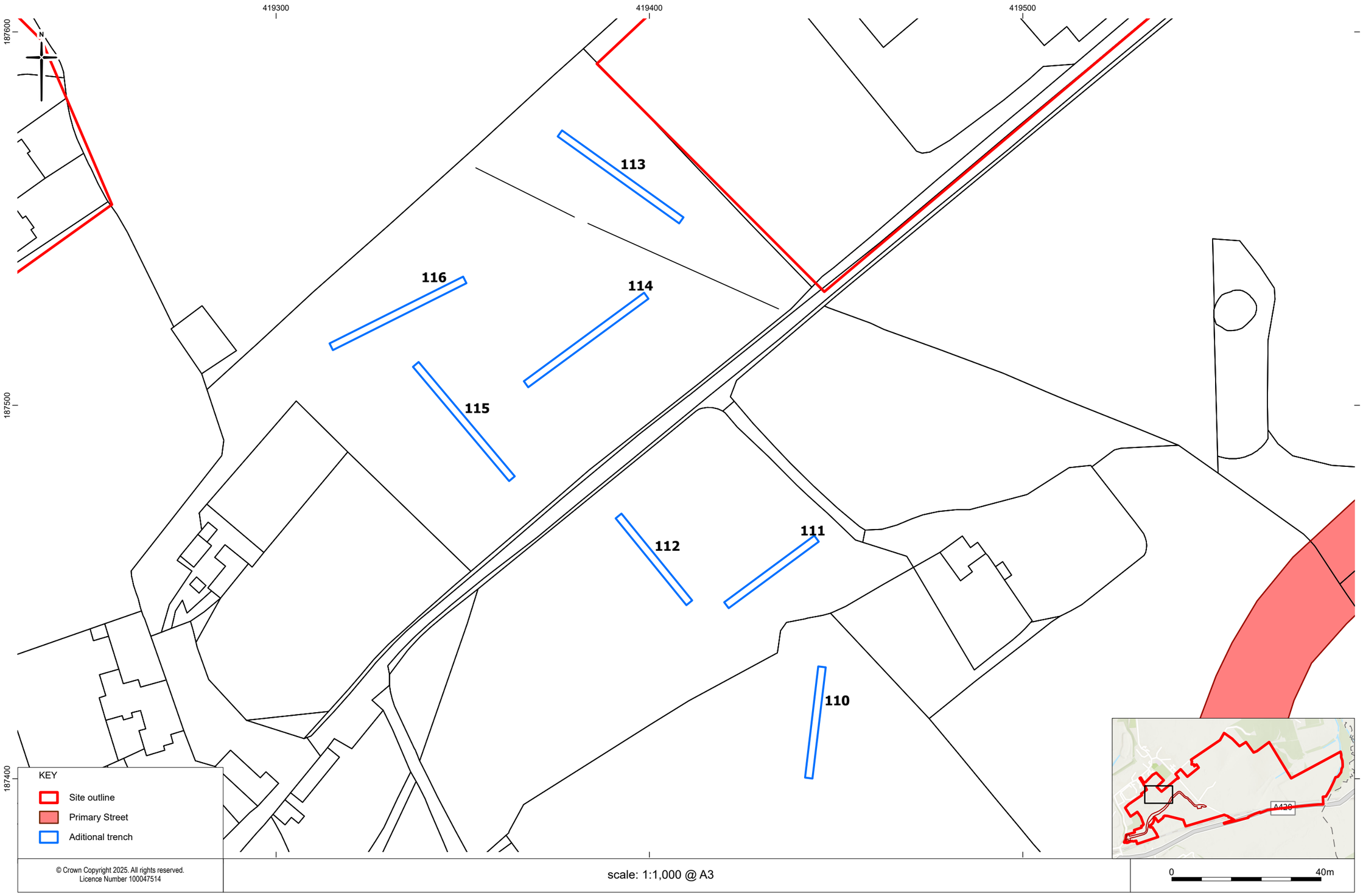

Fig 2 Additional trenches

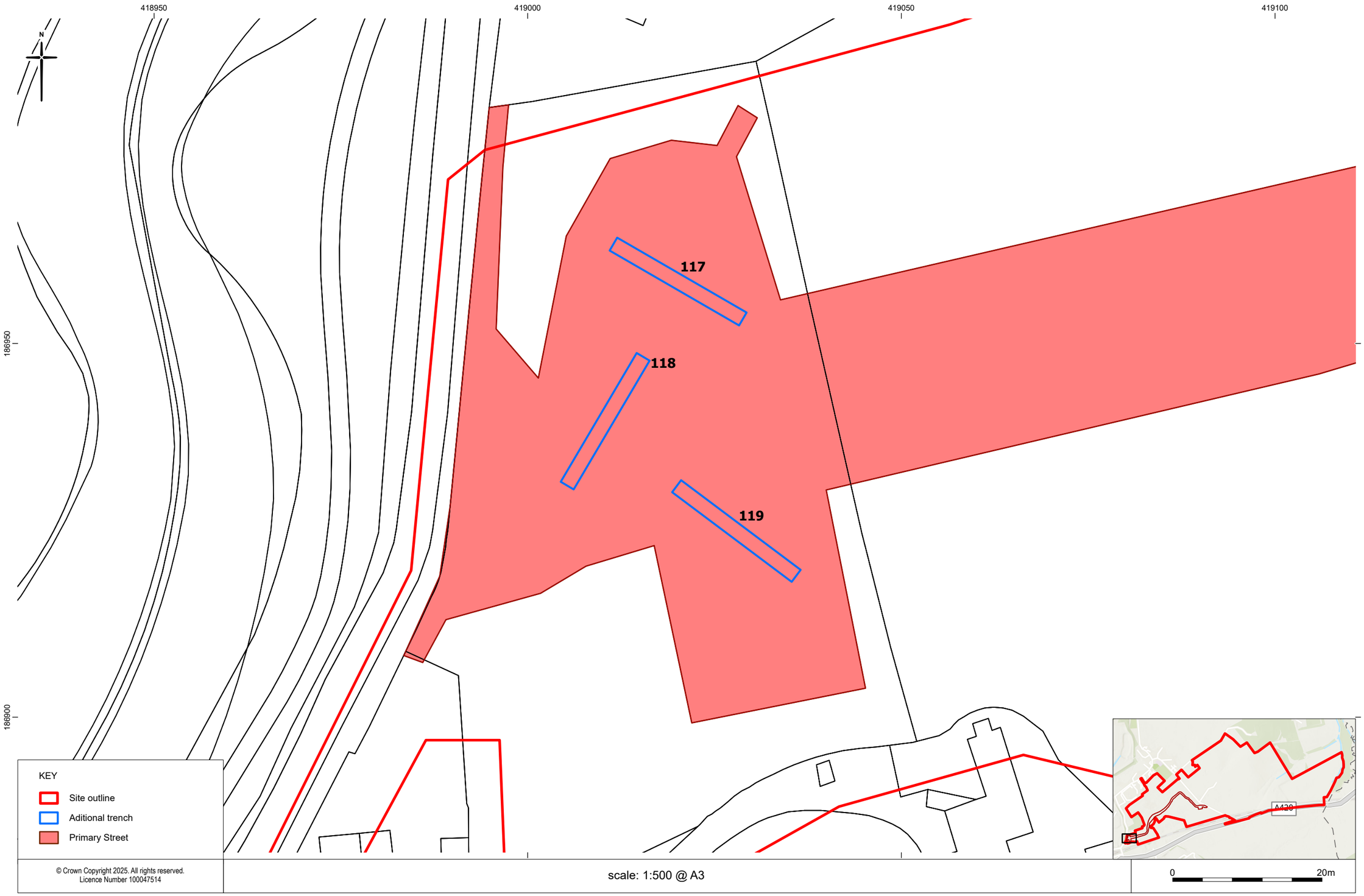

Fig 3 Additional trenches in Primary Street Field 10